



ULTRA AVIATION SERVICES, INC.

General Operations Manual

SECTION H

LOAD

CONTROL

(LOD)



Section: H Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7
Date: 02/02/2022Table of Contents

	Page
H.1 LOAD CONTROL PRINCIPLES	H-1
H1.1 LOAD CONTROL ROLES	H-1
H.2 REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS	H-2
H.3 LOAD CONTROL RESPONSIBILITIES	H-3
H.3.1 WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION - DISPATCHER	H-3
H.3.2 LOAD PLANNER	H-4
H.3.3 LOAD SUPERVISOR	H-5
H.4 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS	H-6
H.4.1 LOAD PLANNING PROCEDURE	H-6
H.4.2 SUPERVISION OF AIRCRAFT LOADING	H-9
H.4.3 WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION	H-10
H.4.3.1 MANUAL WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION	H-11
H.4.3.2 MANAGING DISCREPANCIES	H-11
H.4.4 LAST MINUTE CHANGES	H-11
H.4.5 LOAD INFORMATION EXCHANGE	H-14
H.4.6 REMOTE LOAD CONTROL	H-14
H.4.7 POST-DEPARTURE MESSAGES	H-14
H.5 WEIGHT RECORDING	H-15
H.5.1 BULK LOAD	H-15
H.5.2 UNIT LOAD DEVICE	H-15
H.6 DEPARTURE CONTROL SYSTEM (DCS) PROCESS	H-15
H.6.1 AIRLINE APPROVED DCS FOR LOAD CONTROL	H-15
H.6.2 DATA FOR WEIGHT AND BALANCE	H-15
H.7 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS SCHEMATIC	H-16
H.7.1 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS LEGEND	H-17
H.7.2 OPERATIONS & COMMUNICATIONS PROCEDURE	H-18



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

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Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.1 LOAD CONTROL PRINCIPLES

The safety of a flight requires accurate planning, recording and reporting of all actual load boarded on an aircraft. Documented communication is required to ensure correct weight & balance calculations are conducted prior to an aircraft's departure.

Load Control is an essential process with the purpose of ensuring that the aircraft is safely loaded within operational limits, considering both the weight and center-of-gravity parameters of the aircraft. To ensure flight safety, all items to be loaded into an aircraft must be precisely planned, documented and filed.

The Load Control Process consists of the following procedures:

- Load Planning
- Weight and Balance Calculation
- Supervision of the loading of the aircraft
- Verification and Finalization of the Loadsheet and other loading document
- Communication with the Pilot in Command (NOTOCs) regarding Dangerous Goods, Live Animals onboard, final fuel load, and loadsheet approval.
- Finalization of the Loadsheet including any last minute changes such as modifications to the load plan, fuel uplift, or special loads.
- Documentation of the Load Control Process
- Any additional requirements by the customer airline.

Each customer airline will have their own specific procedures in place which must be followed.

H.1.1 LOAD CONTROL ROLES

The load control process consists of the following roles:

- **Load Planner** - Instructions for loading are provided to the Load Supervision Agent by the carrier based on the expected load of fuel, passengers and cargo.
- **Weight and Balance Calculation** - In most cases the weight and balance of the aircraft is performed by the carrier. Either the Pilot in Command or a licensed Dispatcher will certify the weight and balance calculation prior to each flight.
- **Load Supervision** - Supervision of the loading of the aircraft is done by the Airside Coordinator. The Airside coordinator will ensure that the aircraft is loaded according to the loadsheet and communicate any last minute changes to the dispatch center and the pilot in command for final weight and balance calculation.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.2 REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS**LOD 3.1.3**

- Load Control can be performed directly by the customer airline, a third party or by properly trained Ultra personnel.
- Load Control may be performed manually or with a computerized Departure Control System (DCS) approved by the operator.

Operational load control records must be retained in accordance with all applicable regulatory and operating airline requirements to include:

- Training and qualification records for personnel that perform load control functions;
- Load control documentation for each flight in accordance with requirements of the operating airline;

The Load Control process must have an audit trail for each departure.

- [Weight and balance records must be filed for each flight and retained for a period in accordance with applicable regulations and/or requirements of the operating airline, but no less than a period of three months.](#)
- The operating airline will identify specific loading positions within each aircraft type for the purpose of planning and positioning the load in the aircraft.
- The operating airline will specify requirements for presenting load information in load documents, reports and messages.
- Forms used in the Load Control process must be in compliance with the operating airline's Operations manual.
- All scales (weighbridges) used for weight determination of load and clearance measuring systems must be calibrated and/or checked at intervals determined by the operating carrier or state.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.3 LOAD CONTROL RESPONSIBILITIES

H.3.1 WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION - DISPATCHER

- Requirements:**
- Certification from the Customer Airline
 - DOT FAA Drug Program Compliance
 - FAA License

Duties and Responsibilities:

- Obtain specific aircraft operational data from the customer airline.
- Create and File Flight Plan
- Determine provisional fuel uplift requirement and confirm final fuel uplift with the Captain.
- Provide Meteorological Report for the Flight Crew
- Ensure that the Aircraft weight and balance conditions are correct and within limits.
- Ensure that the Aircraft is loaded in accordance with the specific loading instructions.
- Ensure that information about dangerous goods and other special loads is taken into account.
- Ensure that the load sheet reflects that actual loading of the aircraft, including last minute changes (LMC).
- Communicate all load control information to the Pilot in Command and the operational control center of the customer airline.
- Ensure that operational messages and notifications are sent to the relevant parties.
- Approve and File all documentation
- At a location where ACARS is used, finalization of the weight and balance calculation procedure may differ.

NOTE: This function is primarily performed by the carrier.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.3.2 LOAD PLANNER**LOD 1.2.2, 1.2.3, 1.2.4****Requirements:**

- Approved Training by the Customer Airline
- DOT FAA Drug Program Compliance

Duties and Responsibilities:

- The load planning task may be performed by the same person who performs the weight and balance, but should not be performed by the same person who is supervising the load.
- Ensure Access and obtain the following Aircraft , Load, and Operational Data
 - i. Aircraft basic weight and index
 - ii. Planned Crew
 - iii. Planned Pantry Type
 - iv. Fuel Load and Distribution
 - v. Aircraft limitations related to technical issues
 - vi. Aircraft Planned Equipment, including Unit Load Devices (ULDs).
 - vii. Equipment in Compartment (EIC) / Fly-Away Kit.
 - viii. Operational Limitations related to airport at departure, destination and nominated alternate airport(s).
 - ix. Planning for special load requirements
 - x. Ballast Requirements
 - xi. Specific requirements of the customer airline.
- Ensure Access and obtain the following Flight Load Data
 - xii. Planned deadload and special cargo
 - xiii. Expected passenger load
 - ix. Expected transit loads, if applicable
- Create the Load Information Report (LIR) or Load Plan Sheet.
- Create Notification to Captain (NOTOC) when applicable.
- Determine provisional fuel uplift requirement and confirm final fuel uplift with the Captain.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.3.3 LOAD SUPERVISOR

LOD 1.3.1, 1.3.2

Requirements:

- Approved Training by the Customer Airline

Duties and Responsibilities:

- Monitor and Document offload and report any variance to incoming Load Message to the customer airline.
- Confirm the transit load location, ULDs and bulk load are in accordance with the Transit Load information received from the loading station and report any variance to Load Control for onward flight and the customer airline.
- Supervise the loading and unloading of the aircraft.
- Confirm that the aircraft has been loaded in accordance with the Load Information Report (LIR).
- Advise the Load Planner of any deviation from planned load or loading and any special, overweight or nonstandard items presented for loading not already included on the LIR.
- Confirm and Communicate the Final Load Sheet and provide a copy to the person responsible for producing the final load sheet and to the Company operations office for communication to the necessary parties and filing.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS

The Load control process consists of the following tasks:

- **Load Planning** - Creation of the Load sheet / Load Instructions Report (LIR) based on the anticipated load.
- **Aircraft Load / Offload Supervision** - Responsible to ensure that the aircraft is loaded in accordance with the LIR and communication of any last minute changes to the person performing the weight and balance calculations.
- **Weight and Balance Calculation** - Finalization of the Load Sheet and based on the actual load of the aircraft to ensure that the aircraft has been loaded within operational limits.

H.4.1 LOAD PLANNING PROCEDURE

The goal of this procedure is to produce the Loadsheet or Load Instruction Report (LIR) which ensures that loads are planned safely and distributed in the aircraft compartments and/or holds within aircraft limits. In order to accomplish this the load planner shall:

- a) Check aircraft basic weight/index (BW/BI)
- b) Check all items to be included in the dry operating weight/index. (DOW/DOI).
- c) Check operational messages from the previous flight or leg, including any special loads, if applicable.
- d) Check aircraft operational limitations or any other restrictions that may limit load planning
- e) Calculate expected traffic load.
- f) Check any other dangerous goods and special loads (DGSL) that require special handling and segregations.
- g) Plan unit load devices (ULDs), taking into consideration the expected loading figures, the aircraft configuration and specific operator requirements.
- h) Allocate loading positions for all traffic load and special loads, if applicable, taking into consideration all flight legs.
- i) Calculate the estimated zero fuel weight and transmit to flight dispatch, as applicable, for flight planning purposes.
- j) The Zero Fuel Weight should be communicated every time there is a significant difference from the previous calculations, as per operator requirements.
- k) Check fuel load and distribution.
- l) Perform a pre-calculation of the aircraft weight and balance. This should be done to ensure that the
- m) Give consideration to aircraft ground stability to avoid tail tipping, as per operator requirements and aircraft specifications.
- n) Produce the Load Sheet / Load Instructions Report (LIR).
- o) Produce Notification to the Pilot in Command (NOTOC).

NOTE: This procedure is normally performed by the customer airline.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

A. Loading Instructions - Load Sheet / Load Instruction Report (LIR)

- Loading Instructions must be issued for each departing flight, to ensure that all safety parameters specific to each flight are met.
- Complete load distribution for the departing flight, using provisional data according to the customer airlines requirements.
- Any information that could affect loading should be communicated on the load sheet.
- A signed LIR (manual or electronic) is issued for each flight and includes the following:
 - Load planner or controller and contact details;
 - Hold content instructions;
 - Planned baggage;
 - Planned cargo, mail and EIC;
 - Mobility aids;
 - Hold baggage that exceeds normal allowances
 - Gate delivery items that exceed normal allowances
 - Other non-normal load items.
 - Priority baggage;
 - DAA baggage if applicable;
 - Crew baggage (for placement and not weight recording);
 - Transfer or connection baggage;
 - Summary of Dangerous Goods/Special Loads;
 - Flight details, which may include date, registration, issue number, etc.;
 - Any other requirements of the operating airline.

B. Offloading Instructions

- Off-Loading Instructions may be issued prior to aircraft arrival in the form of an LIR/OIR (manual or electronic) for incoming/transit flights. Refer to upline CPM and/or LDM, and include the following:
 - Baggage details (in handling sequence and priorities required by the operating airline);
 - Cabin Load;
 - Containers and pallets;
 - Cargo, mail and EIC;
 - Mobility aids for gate delivery;
 - Summary of DG/SL;
 - Any relevant plain language text/instruction if required;
 - Flight details, which may include date, registration, issue number, etc.;
 - Any other requirements of the operating airline.
- For transit flights the location of transit baggage must be communicated to ensure that the baggage continues on to its correct and final destination.
- Consideration must be given to ensure aircraft stability during the offloading process and passenger disembarkation process.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

C. Notification to the Captain (NOTOC)**LOD 1.5.2, 2.3.1**

The Notification to the captain (NOTOC) is used to inform the PIC of any dangerous goods or special loads carried as cargo or mail on the aircraft. The flight crew must be provided with an accurate and legible written or printed notification concerning dangerous goods and any other special load as required by the operating airline (i.e. PER, AVI, HEG, HUM) onboard the aircraft in the form of a NOTOC (Notification to Captain).

- The NOTOC shall be provided to the Pilot in Charge (PIC) as soon as practical prior to the departure of the aircraft.
- The NOTOC must include accurate and legible information concerning special loads as per the requirements of the customer airline(s) such as:
 - Dangerous Goods (DG)
 - Firearms
 - Live Animals
 - Wheelchair(s) with lithium battery
- Prior to departure the Pilot-in-Command must be notified of any passengers required to travel because they have been the subject of judicial or administrative proceedings.
- Such notification must include dangerous goods or other special load items that have been loaded on the aircraft at a previous departure point and that are to be carried on a subsequent flight.
- Transit or joining NOTOC is presented to the Captain.
- For changes or repositioning of transit dangerous goods or other special loads, a new NOTOC is issued.
- A separate NOTOC shall be prepared for each station enroute.
- The NOTOC must indicate the accurate location on the aircraft where the Dangerous Good or special item was loaded.
- The NOTOC must contain the name and be signed by the individual who prepared the NOTOC, the loading supervisor and the Captain.
- The signed NOTOC verifies:
 - the package was not leaking when inspected;
 - was in acceptable condition prior to loading;
 - was secured inside the ULD or on aircraft compartment floor when loaded.
- The signed NOTOC must be retained in the flight file.
- Must be readily accessible to airport of prior departure and must be communicated to customer airlines flight dispatch.
- The NOTOC Must be transmitted to the next scheduled port of arrival, before the flight has arrived at the destination airport.
The NOTOC must be communicated to the customer airline(s) flight dispatch/ operations control center.
- An adequate number of copies must be issued in order to provide information to all concerned and for file retention.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.2 SUPERVISION OF AIRCRAFT LOADING**LOD 1.3.1, 1.3.2**

Before loading, the hold shall be visually inspected for damage that can affect the load capacity. The loading supervisor must ensure that all the tasks below are performed.

- a) Monitor and document offload and report any variance to the incoming Load Message to the customer airline.
- b) Confirm the transit load location, ULDs and bulk load are in accordance with the Transit Load information received from the loading station and report any variance to Load Control for onward flight and the customer airline.
- c) Ensure compliance between loading instructions and the load presented, including:
 - ULD identification
 - ULD gross weight
 - ULD load information codes (e.g.; X = empty ULD)
 - Special handling codes and complementary information.
 - ULD contour (where applicable)
 - Bulk Load: number of pieces and weight (where applicable)
 - Correct Airport of Unload
 - Preliminary Notice to Captain (NOTOC)
- d) Visually check serviceability of locks and restraints that could affect the load capacity of the aircraft prior to loading.
- e) Ensure ULDs are serviceable, correctly tagged and load is properly secured.
- f) Ensure bulk load is correctly secured.
- g) Ensure lashing/ load spreading is correctly applied.
- h) Ensure all loads, including visible dangerous goods packages, are inspected for leakage and damage prior to loading.
- i) Ensure the holds are free of any foreign objects.
- j) Ensure any deviations are approved by the person responsible for the weight and balance calculation.
- k) Upon completion, confirm the final load according to the procedure defined by the carrier.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.3 WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION**LOD 1.4.1, 1.4.2**

The objective of the weight and balance calculation task is to ensure that a final and accurate load sheet is issued and this has been crosschecked with:

- a) Final Load Instruction Report (LIR) from the person responsible for the load supervision.
- b) Final Passenger Close-Out Data
- c) Final Fuel Figures
- d) All aircraft operational and structural limitations for the appropriate aircraft registration.

Note 1: *If a preliminary loadsheet is produced, one or more criteria may not have been finalized.*

Note 2: *The person designated with the weight and balance calculation must ensure that all data is finalized or confirmed for manual or electronic loadsheet production.*

- e) **A Loadsheet Accuracy Check will continuously be performed prior to production or transmission of the final loadsheet, to include:**
 - Correct Flight Number and Date.
 - Correct Aircraft Registration
 - Correct aircraft operating weight is used according to aircraft type, registration, version, number of crew and pantry.
 - Underload (total traffic load not exceeding the allowed traffic load).
 - Correct entry of transit load data from incoming load-message/loadsheet
 - Correct Passenger Close-Out Data.
 - If containerized aircraft, ULD tare weight is added.
 - **Hold baggage weight and gate delivery items shall be added.**
 - Actual loading positions of dangerous goods and other special load indicated on the NOTOC, if applicable.
 - **Balance calculation and conditions of loaded aircraft, including LMCs are within prescribed limits.**
 - **The loadsheet must be checked against the final LIR and other information related to the actual load received from the aircraft side/gate supervisor.**
 - Any operator-specific requirements are adhered to, if applicable.
 - **All specified documents shall be signed by means of manual or electronic identifiers.**
- f) **The final, signed loadsheet shall be delivered to the PIC either as a hard copy (manual or digital) or ACARS format.**
- g) Any changes occurring after the final loadsheet has been produced must be accounted for by either production of a new edition of the loadsheet or by the documented Last Minute Change process inline with the customer airline's requirements.
- h) If a discrepancy is discovered after the aircraft push-back, the PIC must be informed immediately to prevent and unsafe take off.
- i) **Ensure that the flight/load information required for messaging is passed to the person responsible for sending the post-departure message.**
- j) **Obtain an signed approval by the pilot in command of the flight/load information and retain a copy at the departure station.**



Section: H

Load Control

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.3.1 MANUAL WEIGHT AND BALANCE CALCULATION**LOD 2.2.1, 2.2.2**

If the weight and balance calculation is performed manually instead of using an electronic data processing system (EDP) or computer system, then the **Customer Airline(s) procedures shall be followed and only valid manual load documentation provided or approved by the customer airline may be used.**

In order to perform a weight and balance calculation without the use of an EDP, you will first need the following from the customer airline:

- Aircraft Basic Empty Weight of the specific aircraft in question.
- Aircraft Weight Limits (Maximum Take off weight, Maximum Landing Weight, Compartment Limits, Floor Point load limits).
- Aircraft Center of Gravity Limits and Moments Table for the aircraft.
- The Load Instruction Report (LIR) Worksheet - **MUST BE APPROVED BY THE CARRIER**
- The Load and Trim Sheet for the aircraft type.
- The Required Fuel for the operation to include reserves and alternate airport requirements.
- The loads to be carried on the aircraft (Passengers, Cargo, Mail, Fuel etc.)
- A Calculator



IMPORTANT! - If the above information is not available, then the weight and balance calculation cannot be performed and the flight cannot be operated.

If the above information is available, perform the manual weight and balance calculation as instructed by and according to the customer airline's regulations and procedures.

Basic Weight and Balance Calculation Procedure.

This is only an overview of the steps taken to calculate the weight and balance of the aircraft. In order to perform this function you must be trained and certified by the customer airline. **Always follow the carrier's weight and balance procedures.**

1. Ascertain from the pilot's operating handbook the empty weight of the aircraft and determine the weights of people, baggage, and fuel.
2. Multiply each weight by the arm—the distance from the reference datum—to find the moment.
3. Add all the weights to find the gross weight. Add all the moments to find the total moment.
4. Divide the total moment by the gross weight to find the center of gravity.
5. Locate the total weight and center of gravity on the center of gravity limits chart in your aircraft's POH to determine if the airplane is within allowable limits.
6. Repeat this process for your expected landing weight, as the center of gravity can shift as fuel is consumed
7. Repeat this process if any last minute changes are made after the creation of the final LIR.



Section: H

Load Control

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.3.2 MANAGING DISCREPANCIES**LOD 2.4.1**

In the event of a potential discrepancy associated with the accuracy of the weight and balance figures for a flight, the discrepancy must be reported to the person responsible for the final loadsheet and to the customer airline. In addition, and relevant or requested information must be provided to the PIC immediately without delay.

Any changes occurring after the final loadsheet has been produced must be accounted for by either production of a new edition of the loadsheet as per last minute changes procedure or the operating airline procedures.



IMPORTANT: If a discrepancy is discovered, the **PIC MUST BE INFORMED IMMEDIATELY** to prevent an unsafe takeoff.

Use one of the the following methods below to contact the Pilot in Command:

Before Pushback:	Contact Ultra Operations and/or Ramp Duty Manager to halt the pushback and notify the person responsible for the final load sheet.
During Pushback:	Contact Ultra Operations and/or Ramp Duty Manager to halt the pushback and notify the PIC of the discrepancy. OPS: 305-876-8901
After Pushback / During Taxi :	Contact Ultra Operations to notify the PIC via company VHF Radio Frequency, if the aircraft is no longer monitoring the Ultra VHF radio frequency, then call ATC Ground Control to make the notification.
After Takeoff:	Inform the customer airline immediately. Contact ATC to make the notification or follow guidance given by the carrier.

FAA MIAMI ARTCC - ZMA: 305-716-1500



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.4 LAST MINUTE CHANGES**LOD 1.4.3**

If any Last Minute Changes (LMC) occurs after the completion of the final load sheet, this must be brought to the attention of the flight crew and the LMC must be entered on the final load sheet.

LMC includes:

- changes to the baggage counts and/or weights;
- changes to the cargo, fuel, mail and EIC weights;
- passengers that are added or offloaded from the flight;
- movement of any deadload.
- any differences between in the actual loading of the aircraft and the load plan.

The maximum allowed change in the number of passengers or hold load acceptable as a LMC is specified in the operating airline's Operations Manual. If this number is exceeded, a new final load sheet must be

If the flight crew has already been provided with a final load sheet, the LMC can be transmitted via headset or VHF. The flight crew adds LMC on the original final load sheet copy and Load Control Agent adds LMC on his

If ACARS is available, the adjusted final load sheet or LMC slip may be generated and transmitted to the crew using ACARS.

The person responsible for the final load sheet must check that the aircraft is still within the customer airline's limits.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.4.5 LOAD INFORMATION EXCHANGE**LOD 1.1.1, PAB 1.1.1**

Before departure, a verbal exchange of load information or data that could affect aircraft final weight and balance calculations must be:

- Manually or electronically documented;
- Confirmed prior to flight departure.
- flight information that could have a direct impact on the flight must be incorporated.

Ensure that for any discrepancies associated with the accuracy of the final weight and balance figures for a flight:

- Information is provided to the PIC, flight crew, and the operating airline without delay.
- Loads that exceed limitations must be identified, addressed, and communicated in accordance with customer airline procedures.

H.4.6 REMOTE LOAD CONTROL

Remote Load Control is a process of performing the load planning task and/or weight and balance calculation task for a departing flight from a remote location.

Information exchange is essential for a safe remote Load Control Process. Data shall be transmitted between remote Load Control, departure station and cockpit crew either directly or indirectly, using predetermined means of communication as established by the operator.

H.4.7 POST-DEPARTURE MESSAGES**LOD 1.5.1**

All post-departure messages and any other relevant messages pertaining to flight handling will be sent to the defined stations as per operator requirements. Such messages may include, but are not limited to:

- MVT - Aircraft Movement Message
- LDM—Load Distribution Message
- CPM—Container/Pallet Distribution Message
- UCM—Unit Load Device Control Message
- SLS - Statistical Load Summary
- DIV - Aircraft Diversion Message

Messages must be sent by the originating station to addresses specified by the operating airline.

A flight file shall be maintained for each departing flight in a secure location according to local regulations and/or operator requirements.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.5 WEIGHT RECORDING**H.5.1 BULK LOAD**

If standard baggage weights are not used, calculate the actual weight of bulk baggage using the available data. Follow operating airline policy for standard loading guidelines.

H.5.2 UNIT LOAD DEVICE

ULDs loaded with baggage need not be weighed when standard baggage weights are used. If not, determine the weight of ULDs by the use of a weighbridge, or tally of the individual weights of each piece loaded. If the validity of the indicated weights is in doubt, due to appearance or other circumstances, the ULD must be weighed prior to acceptance. For weight and balance purposes, the recorded weight of the transfer ULD will be used.

H.6 DEPARTURE CONTROL SYSTEM (DCS) PROCESS**H.6.1 AIRLINE APPROVED DCS FOR LOAD CONTROL****LOD 2.1.1, 2.1.2**

If a DCS system is used in the Load Control Process, the aircraft data for the operating airline must be current and include all aircraft operational and load data. The DCS system used shall be approved by the operating airline.

If the company uses an automated departure control system (DCS) other than that of the customer airline for the weight and balance calculation process, then the company shall coordinate and exchange information with the customer airline to ensure that the DCS data is current and maintained.

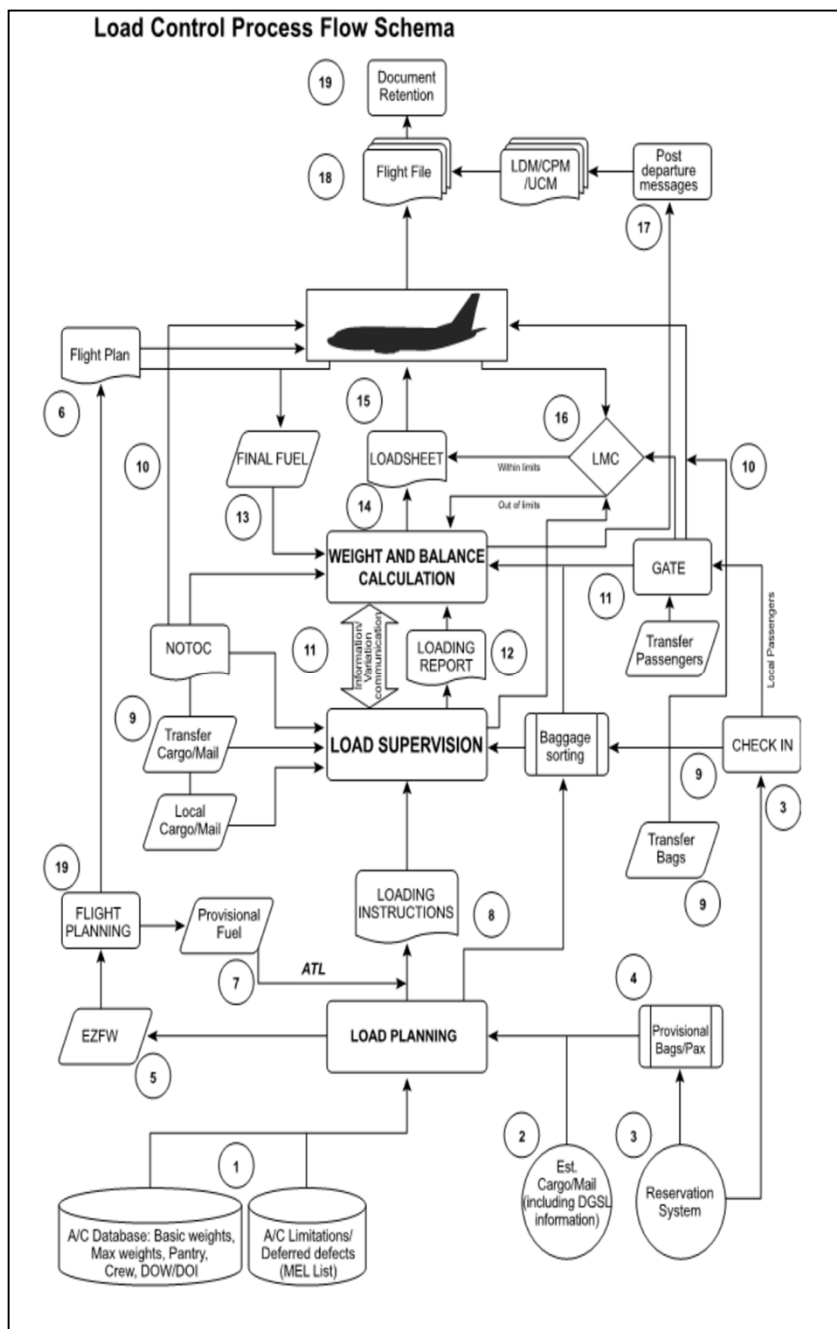
H.6.2 DATA FOR WEIGHT AND BALANCE

At check-in closure, the Load Control Agent records or receives, as per the operating airline requirements:

- the total number of passengers checked-in;
- the total number of males, females, children and infants or number of adults, children and infants (depending on the system used);
- the total weight of baggage;
- the breakdown of seating distribution of passengers within each trim zone.

H.7 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS SCHEMATIC

The Load Control Process diagram below illustrates the overall flow of information and checks and balances that are required to ensure that an aircraft is loaded safely and within operational limits.





Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.7.1 LOAD CONTROL PROCESS LEGEND

1.	Aircraft Designation: access to permanent and semi-permanent data and maintenance data related to limitations that could affect loading and weight and balance.
2.	Estimated/Provisional cargo and mail, data including dangerous goods and special load information, to load planning.
3.	Data from reservation system to capacity calculation (passenger and bag counts) and check in.
4.	Provisional passengers sorted by class and provisional bags according to operator policy to load planning.
5.	Provide the Estimated Zero Fuel Weight (EZFW), to flight planning system.
6.	Operational flight plan to the Pilot in Command (PIC)
7.	Provisional fuel, calculate the allowed traffic load and verify that load planning is within limits.
8.	Loading Instruction to Load Supervision and loading team. Segregation plan to sorting area.
9.	Actual data flowing from check-in (passenger number, baggage pieces and weight, special load information), cargo and mail warehouse (special load information), transfer load.
10.	Load to aircraft.
11.	Load info and variation communication between Load Control and Load Supervision: discrepancies between planned and real load weight, nature and distribution.
12.	Final data confirmation from Loading Supervision and Gate (gate collected items).
13.	Final fuel figures communication from the flight planning system of PIC.
14.	Loadsheet verification and release.
15.	Loadsheet to aircraft
16.	Last Minute Changes.
17.	Post-Departure load messages and dangerous goods and special loads information to station of arrival.
18.	Signed Documents verification and collection.
19.	File archiving and retention.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

H.7.2 OPERATIONS & COMMUNICATIONS PROCEDURE

This load control procedure is followed by the company when handling a departing flight.

1. **Aircraft and Flight Designation** - The customer airline will notify Ultra Operations of a scheduled flight and a flight number, aircraft, crew and scheduled time of arrival/departure will be assigned.
2. **Airport Notification** - Ultra Operations will notify the airport authority, regulatory agencies (TSA, CBP, etc.), company staff and any third parties such as the fuelers, caterers, and/or cargo services and request a gate and any required airport facilities for the operation.
3. **Company Staff Assigned** - The staff required to perform the required duties for the designated operation will be assigned and scheduled to work the flight. (e.g. Passenger Service, Ramp Service, Cabin Service, Security Service).
4. **Position Aircraft** - The aircraft will be positioned at the assigned gate or parking position. This can happen in a number of ways such as a Live Arrival or Inbound Ferry, a Tow from another parking position or maintenance hangar, or the aircraft could already be in position from a previous operation. Park, chock, place cones and loading bridge on the aircraft in accordance with Section J.
5. **Provisional Data** - The carrier will supply the estimated traffic loads to handling company including the estimated passenger count, the amount of baggage, cargo, dangerous good and any special loads and special services .
6. **Load Planning** - If the company is performing the load plan for the aircraft, then follow the procedures provided by the carrier or the procedure in this section. If the carrier is performing the load plan, then the customer airline will either provide a loadsheets (LIR) to the handling company or provisional loading instructions which will be finalized by the pilot in command at the aircraft.
7. **Passenger Check-In** - For a passenger flight, the counter is normally opened for passenger check-in four (4) hours prior to departure. Passenger service staff must be present, the Ground Security Coordinator (GSC) is assigned, the baggage agent is in place, the Departure Control System (DCS) is accessible and the information for the flight is loaded.
8. **Cabin Service** - If the aircraft is arriving via Live or Ferry flight then cabin services will be notified to clean the aircraft and remove any regulated garbage.
9. **Aircraft Access** - Once an aircraft is assigned and opened for an operation, aircraft access must be controlled and documented. A security agent should be placed at the aircraft door and on the ramp.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

10. **Airside Safety and Load Supervision** - The Load Plan or carrier instructions must be obtained. An Aircraft walk-around should be performed along with a Foreign Object Debris (FOD) sweep and give loading instructions to the ramp crew. **See Aircraft Safety and Load Supervision Procedures.**
11. **Aircraft Loading - Ramp Service** normally begins two (2) hours prior to departure. Verify that the required ground service equipment GSE is in safe operating condition and positioned at the gate. Ramp Service staff must be present with safety vest on. *Prior to entering the aircraft bin, each ramp agent must be checked by security.* Begin aircraft loading as instructed by the Load Supervisor in accordance with the load instructions report (LIR). If for any reason, the aircraft cannot be loaded as indicated on the loadsheets then notify the load supervisor immediately.
12. **Flight Plan** - Confirm that the flight plan has been filed by the carrier. Obtain a copy of the flight plan and provide a copy to the PIC at the aircraft.
13. **Aircraft Fueling** - If a provisional fuel load has been provided by the customer airline(s) operational control center (OCC) then request fuel uplift and verify the final fuel load with the PIC.
14. **Catering** - Verify that catering has been completed as per the carriers instructions if necessary.
15. **Close Passenger Check-in** - One (1) hour prior to departure the check-in counter should be closed the final passenger and baggage count information must be given to the person responsible for creating the final loadsheets.
16. **Close Bagroom** - Verify that all of the baggage that has been checked in for the flight, including oversized and overweight pieces, has reached that bagroom and has been recorded on the baggage manifest.
17. **Crew Authorization to Board** - Verify that all cabin crew are present and accounted for and prepared to begin passenger boarding.
18. **Board Passengers** - 30-45 minutes prior to departure begin the passenger boarding process in accordance with customer airline(s) procedures.
19. **All Baggage to the Aircraft** - Confirm that all of the baggage from the bagroom has been delivered to the aircraft for loading.
20. **Complete Aircraft Loading** - Bring down any gate checked items such as wheelchairs and strollers and finalize the loadsheets. Provide a signed copy to the PIC. Make any final adjustments requested by the PIC as he/she makes their final weight and balance calculations.



Section: H

Load Control (LOD)

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

21. **Complete Boarding Process** - Board all passengers and confirm passenger count by the DCS with the headcount performed by the cabin crew. Notify the crew and airside supervisor of any missing passengers in case any baggage must be removed from the aircraft prior to departure.
22. **Secure the Cargo Bins** - Move all GSE away from the aircraft except for the paymover. Verify that all cargo loads have been secured properly and close the cargo bins.
23. **Finalize the Loadsheet** - Obtain final signed and approved loadsheets from the Pilot in Command (PIC) and provide a copy to Ultra Operations and to the customer airline for file retention and documentation.
24. **Prepare for Departure** - Follow Pre-Departure handling procedures. Close all doors, remove loading bridge.
25. **Perform Pushback** - Confirm that wing walkers are in place, Headset is connected and the cabin crew has received clearance and given permission to pushback.
26. **Position Aircraft for Taxi and Departure** - Once the aircraft is in position for departure on the taxi way, remove the towbar and paymover from the aircraft, perform engine start up and clear away from the aircraft by following the departure procedure.
27. **Receive Final Departure Times** - Once airborne, the PIC will contact Ultra Operations via ground to air radio and communicate the final departure times, passenger counts, along with an estimated time of arrival (ETA) into the next station and any special services requests.
28. **Send Post-Departure Message** - Notify the customer airline and any necessary third-parties of the aircraft's departure. Include any or all of the relevant messages below.
 - MVT - Aircraft Movement Message
 - LDM—Load Distribution Message
 - CPM—Container/Pallet Distribution Message
 - UCM—Unit Load Device Control Message
 - SLS - Statistical Load Summary
29. **Flight Documentation** - Retain a copy of all flight documentation as per regulatory and customer airline requirements.



ULTRA AVIATION SERVICES, INC.

General Operations Manual

Section: H

Load Control

Revision: 7

Date: 02/02/2022

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